

2012 年全国大学生英语竞赛 C 类决赛赛卷

2012 National English Contest for College Students

(Level C — Final)

(总分:150 分 时间:120 分钟)

Part I Listening Comprehension (30 marks)

Section A (5 marks)

In this section, you will hear five short conversations. Each conversation will be read only once. At the end of each conversation, there will be a twenty-second pause. During the pause, read the question and the three choices marked A, B and C, and decide which is the best answer. Then mark the corresponding letter on the Answer Sheet with a single line through the centre.

1. What does the woman think about the job application?
A. She is not quite confident about it.
B. She has got better qualifications.
C. She might be lucky to succeed.
2. Why does the woman support immigration?
A. She thinks it is right to share resources.
B. She thinks immigration brings job opportunities.
C. She thinks they've got enough immigrants.
3. How does the woman think about retirement?
A. It's most people's desire.
B. People don't need to retire early.
C. It shouldn't be seen as an illness.
4. Why do students join in the activity of 40-hour Famine?
A. To raise money for buying food and water for poor students.
B. To promote awareness of cherishing what one has got now.
C. To draw attention to poor people suffering from famine.
5. What does the woman most probably do?
A. She is a director. B. She is an actress. C. She is a student.

Section B (10 marks)

In this section, you will hear two long conversations. Each conversation will be read only once. At

the end of each conversation, there will be a **one-minute** pause. During the pause, read the questions, each with **three** choices marked **A**, **B** and **C**, and decide which is the best answer. Then mark the corresponding letter on the **Answer Sheet** with a single line through the centre.

Conversation One

6. How many fare-constructed sections are made on land?
A. 54,000. B. 45,000. C. 50,000.
7. What's the main difference between maglev trains and conventional trains?
A. Maglev trains travel on rails.
B. Maglev trains don't have wheels.
C. Maglev trains travel at 300 km/h.
8. Where was the idea of maglev trains firstly invented?
A. In Germany. B. In the U.S.A.. C. In the U.K..
9. Why are maglev trains free of noise?
A. They don't use rails.
B. They run under water.
C. They travel at high speed.
10. What might cause damage to an underwater maglev train?
A. Ships at sea.
B. A train from the opposite direction.
C. The powerful ocean

Conversation Two

11. Which organization does the guest work for?
A. Engineers without Borders.
B. Doctors without Borders.
C. Care Canada.
12. When did George and Parker start to have the inspiration?
A. After they dropped out of school.
B. After they started their work.
C. Before they graduated from college.
13. What's the initial idea for setting up such an organization?
A. To purify water in developing countries.
B. To improve people's life with the help of technology.
C. To help people in poor nations get medical care.
14. What would they do with next-state projects?
A. To implement some of the technologies.
B. To engage more engineers.
C. To conduct more experiments.

15. Who provide them with the seed funding to keep the project going?

- A. The government.
- B. Suncor Energy Foundation and Ontario Power Generation.
- C. Individuals in the community.

Section C (5 marks)

In this section, you will hear five short news items. Each item will be read only once. At the end of each item, there will be a pause. During the pause, read the question and the three choices marked A, B and C, and decide which is the best answer. Then mark the corresponding letter on the Answer Sheet with a single line through the centre.

16. How long did the first Thanksgiving Day last?

- A. Three weeks.
- B. Two weeks.
- C. Three days.

17. What is the purpose of American Jobs Act calling for cutting wage taxes?

- A. To prevent public employees from losing their jobs.
- B. To call for less spending on roads and infrastructure.
- C. To encourage more people to look for jobs.

18. Why does the problem of debts affect a lot more nations than just the ones that are struggling with money?

- A. The nations use the same currency.
- B. The nations have joint business corporations.
- C. These nations' economies are interdependent.

19. How much money can each child beggar earn a day for their minders?

- A. Dozens of dollars.
- B. Hundreds of dollars.
- C. A dozen or so dollars.

20. Why did Spain's top footballers hold a strike?

- A. Leading players got killed in a row.
- B. Two important games were postponed.
- C. There was a pay dispute.

Section D (10 marks)

In this section, you will hear a short passage. There are 10 missing words or phrases. Fill in the blanks with the exact words or phrases you hear. The passage will be read twice. Remember to write the answers on the Answer Sheet.

Millions of television sets and old computer monitors taken to civic amenity sites as rubbish are being collected and shipped to Africa and Asia, an illegal trade worth £ 7,000,000 a year, according to an unpublished report by the Environment Agency and the (21) _____. The business carried out by totters—people who sift through rubbish for saleable objects—became illegal on the 1st of January 2002 under European Union legislation (22) _____ prevent toxic waste material being shipped to developing countries.

Electrical equipment (23) _____ leaded glass, particularly computers and televisions, were

reclassified as toxic waste. The agency is alarmed that half a million televisions and a similar number of computer monitors which people thought were being (24) _____ in England are being re-used or dumped in the developing world.

The agency is finding the trade hard to control but is planning to publish guidance to the industry soon. Environment groups point out that this action will not be (25) _____ to stop an illegal business.

Claire Wilton of Friends of the Earth said, "The agency has known about this situation for two years but has still (26) _____ act. The companies involved in this illegal trade must be prevented from dumping Britain's toxic waste on developing countries, where workers' conditions rarely match those expected in Europe." Action must be taken now to stop this environmental (27) _____ continuing.

The Industry Council for Electronic Equipment Recycling estimates that 11,000 tons of old TV sets, about 500,000 (28) _____, and a similar number of old computer monitors find their way to developing countries each year. Many are cannibalized for spare parts but some are repaired and sold to people who would not (29) _____ have a television or computer.

The Industry Council for Electronic Equipment Recycling defends its members who buy computers and other office equipment from industry and ship them abroad, because under EU rules the business is legal if they are working models and intended to be sold on the second-hand market. The problem arises when equipment is thrown away. The law says if it is (30) _____, even if it may be working, it must be classed as rubbish and cannot be resold to a developing country because it is technically toxic waste.

Part II Vocabulary and Structure (15 marks)

There are 15 incomplete sentences in this section. For each blank there are four choices marked A, B, C and D. Choose the one that best completes the sentence. Then mark the corresponding letter on the Answer Sheet with a single line through the centre.

31. The president's education speeches contained _____ the tongue leading to public confusion over education policy.
A. a slide of B. a slip of C. a skip of D. a glide of
32. The word "right", in most languages, is usually connected _____ the meaning of "correct", whereas the words associate _____ "left", generally have negative meanings.
A. to; with B. with; to C. to; to D. with; with
33. Gas prices rose 4% in April, a _____ rise but the smallest since January.
A. mighty B. severe C. steep D. massive
34. It seems a very simple thing to tell the truth, but beyond all question, there is nothing _____ lying.
A. half so easy as B. so half easy as C. half easy as D. so easy as half
35. _____ until recently, people who are left-handed have been considered abnormal.
A. Up B. Unless C. Down D. Not

36. Sorry about the loss. But it'll give you some relief if your house is _____ against fire.
A. assured B. ensured C. insured D. pledged
37. When _____ in a downpour without an umbrella or a raincoat, most people would pick up their pace.
A. sunk B. caught C. plunged D. grabbed
38. In 1993, V. S. Naipaul was awarded the David Cohen British Literature Prize in _____ of his lifetime's achievement.
A. identification B. acquaintance C. recognition D. perspective
39. Many linguists _____ that our highly evolved brain provides us with innate language ability not found in lower organisms.
A. suggest B. claim C. promise D. convince
40. I'm in a slightly _____ position in that he is not arriving until 12:00 which is 3 hours late.
A. tight B. weird C. awesome D. awkward
41. Tactless she may be, but ungrateful _____ think her
A. should not you B. should you not C. not should you D. you should not
42. More than 30 people died in the train accident, most of _____ children.
A. which B. them C. whom D. that
43. He admits that his team really _____ him to play a role of responsibility.
A. look forward to B. look down on C. look up to D. look on
44. —Do you know the students have been protesting against the increased tuition?
—I've heard about the protest, but _____
A. I've joined in it to support the students. B. I don't see any good it will do.
C. I do know the reason for it. D. I think it'll be a great success.
45. —I hear you're a journalist now, Paul. That must be exciting.
—_____ most of the time. But like all jobs, it has its disadvantages.
A. It's boring B. It's a piece of cake
C. It has drawbacks D. It's a buzz

Part III Cloze (10 marks)

Read the following passage and fill in each blank with **one** word. Fill in the following blanks in one of the **three** ways: according to the context, by using the correct form of the given word, or by using the given letter(s) of the word. Remember to write the answers on the **Answer Sheet**.

There is a phenomenon that sociologists call reference anxiety—or, more popularly, keeping up with the (46) Jo _____. According to that thinking, most people judge their possessions in comparison with others'. People tend not to ask themselves, "Does my house meet my needs?" (47) Ins _____ they ask, "Is my house nicer than my neighbor's?" If your two-bedroom house is surrounded by three-and four-bedroom houses, with some (48) ar _____ the corner doing a tear-down to build a McMansion, your reference anxiety may rise. Suddenly that two-bedroom house—one that your grandparents might have considered quite nice, even luxurious—doesn't seem

enough. And so the money you spent on it stops (49) _____ (provide) you with a sense of wellbeing.

Americans' soaring reference anxiety is a product of the widening gap in income (50) _____ (distribute). In other words, the rich are getting richer faster, and the rest of the population are none too happy about it. During much of the U.S. history, the (51) _____ (major) lived in small towns or urban areas where conditions for most people were approximately the same—hence, low (52) _____ anxiety. Also, most people knew relatively little about those who were living higher on the hog.

But in the past few (53) de _____, new economic forces have changed all that. Rapid growth in income for the top 5 percent of households has brought (54) ab _____ a substantial cohort of people who live notably better than the middle class does, amplifying our reference anxiety. That wealthier minority is occupying ever-larger homes and spending more on each change of clothes when the middle is doing O. K. In nations with (55) h _____ levels of income equality like the Scandinavian countries, well-being tends to be higher than in nations with unequal wealth distribution such as the United States.

Part IV Reading Comprehension (40 marks)

Read the following passages. Each passage is followed by several questions. Respond to the questions using information from the passage. Remember to write the answers on the Answer Sheet.

Section A (10 marks)

Questions 56—60 are based on the following passage.

Several research groups in the United States are conducting genetic research aimed at retarding aging. If the breakthroughs of recent years are anything to go by, it is likely that we will see several-fold longevity increases in mice within the next decade or so. Already such genetic manipulation has increased by almost 50% the life span of flies. Results are also promising in mammals; scientists have extended longevity in mice by 50% through genetic interventions. Achieving similar results in humans will be harder. Scientists have already identified genes that appear to accelerate human aging, but they have yet to find genes with the opposite effect. But with the sequencing of the human genome, we are now in a better position to find out more about aging in humans as well as animals.

For those who cannot wait, there is one method available today that might delay human aging: caloric restriction. This means simply a diet with few calories. Experiments have shown longevity increases of more than 50% in certain mammals that follow such diets. Most people, however, feel that the secondary effects of this outweigh the benefits. After all, what is the point of living longer if you cannot enjoy life? If science is to extend human longevity, it will have to do so by extending the duration of human life in age-related disability. The extra years of life must allow future grandparents to enjoy life, not just live.

Although some scientists argue that aging will never be cured and our grandparents will continue to fit our stereotypes, many others remain confident that we will soon learn how to modulate

the human aging process. "I believe our generation is the first to be able to map a possible route to individual immortality," says William Haseltine, CEO of Human Genome Sciences Inc. in Rockville, Maryland. If a therapy could slow human aging by 50%, for instance, we could have 30 or 40 more years of life. In that time, new discoveries could be made that would allow us to live even longer, and the cycle could continue until a cure for aging is discovered. "It's possible that some people alive now may still be alive 400 years from now," claims gerontologist S. Michal Jazwinski of Louisiana State of University Health Sciences Center. But what would be consequences of extending human longevity or finding a real cure for aging?

Questions 56—60

Complete the summary with words from the passage, changing the form where necessary, with only one word for each blank.

Researchers have achieved success in (56) _____ the aging of flies. But similar results in humans are not encouraging. Other than finding genes that slow down human aging, scientists have identified genes that appear to (57) _____ it. However, there might be one way of delaying aging, i.e. caloric (58) _____ which means following certain diets with few calories. Meanwhile, it is necessary to think about the significance of living longer and how to (59) _____ the aging process. Some optimistic people believe that it is possible to extend human longevity while others are quite concerned about the (60) _____ of it.

Section B (10 marks)

Questions 61—65 are based on the following passage.

No matter how carefully you plan a trip with a friend, or family member, there will probably be conflicts along the way. Even after the dates, destination, and length of the trip are decided, there's still the chance that problems could happen on the trip.

Here are a few tips to help you solve problems that may come up between you and your travel companion:

Plan the trip together: Sometimes one person takes the lead and plan the trip to fit his or her interests. Planning together allows for a more diverse and balanced vacation. Some people want to walk; some



people would rather use public transportation. So it's important to find out how compatible you are in terms of everything concerned.

Find out about lifestyle: Differences in lifestyle can be challenging if they haven't been discussed in advance. There's nothing worse than being in the room and awake at 6:00 a.m. when your companion wants to sleep until noon. Sleep patterns can be very disruptive to people that don't have the same pattern. The same can be said for dietary and other restrictions. Knowing those differences in advance helps people adapt to each other more quickly.

Be aware of coping strategies: Ask questions and use your understanding of your companion's coping strategies—how they may respond to stressful situations. You can ask your travel companion about his/her best and worst trips. What happened? How did that person respond? Knowing a little about how your companion deals with difficult situations can be helpful.

Compromise: Try to compromise in order to have a good time. Agree to disagree. Do you really want to use your energy feeling anger on your vacation when you should be relaxing and enjoying it? Buy travel journals for yourself and your travel partners. Writing in journals can be a way to reflect on the trip to relieve some of the frustration that may come up.

Take a break: Split up when tensions are high and your interests are different. Be sure to set a time and meeting place and have a backup meeting set in case of an unforeseen delay. People tend to feel like they have to stick together when they are together on a trip. But anybody with someone 24 hours a day needs a break from the other person.

Questions 61—63

Decide whether the following statements are **true (T)** or **false (F)** according to the passage.

61. This passage aims to help travelers solve problems between them and their travel partners.
62. Lifestyle differences can cause travel problems because all people enjoy sleeping till noon when on vacation.
63. Even though your travel interests are different, you must always stay together with your travel partners.

Questions 64—65

Answer the following questions according to the passage.

64. Why do people have to ask their travel companion about his/her best and worst trips?
65. Which way might help relieve the frustration that may come up?

Section C (10 marks)

Questions 66—70 are based on the following passage.

Knowing that Mrs. Mallard was afflicted with a heart trouble, great care was taken to break to her as gently as possible the news of her husband's death.

She did not hear the story as many women have heard the same, with a paralyzed inability to accept its significance. She wept at once, with sudden, wild abandonment, in her sister's arms. When the storm of grief had passed she went away to her room alone. She refused to have anyone

follow her.

There stood, facing the open window, a comfortable, roomy armchair. Into this she sank, pressed down by a physical exhaustion that filled her body and seemed to reach into her soul.

She sat with her head thrown back upon the cushion of the chair, quite motionless, except when a sob came up into her throat and shook her, as a child who has cried itself to sleep continues to sob in its dreams.

She was young, with a fair, calm face, whose lines indicated repression and even a certain strength. But now there was a dull stare in her eyes, whose gaze was fixed away off in the distance on a patch of blue sky. It was not a glance of reflection, but rather indicated a suspension of intelligent thought.

There was something coming to her and she was waiting for it, fearfully. What was it? She did not know; it was too subtle and elusive to name. But she felt it, creeping out of the sky, reaching toward her through the wounds, the scents, the color that filled the air.

Now her bosom rose and fell with excitement. She was beginning to recognize this thing that was approaching to possess her, and she was struggling to beat it back with her will, as powerless as her two white slender hands would have been.

When she abandoned herself a little whispered word escaped her slightly parted lips. She said it over and over under her breath, "free, free, free!" The empty stare and the look of terror that had followed it went from her eyes. They stayed sharp and bright. Her pulses beat fast, and the coursing blood warmed and relaxed every inch of her body.

She did not stop to ask if it were or were not a monstrous joy that held her. A clear and exalted perception enabled her to dismiss the suggestion as of little importance.

She knew that she would weep again when she saw the kind, tender hands folded in death; the face that had never looked except with love upon her, fixed and gray and dead. But she saw beyond that bitter moment a long procession of years to come that would belong to her absolutely. And she opened and spread her arms out to them in welcome.

Questions 66—68

Complete the following sentences with information given in the passage in **a maximum of 2 words** for each blank.

66. Most women were shocked into a _____ on hearing the news of their husbands' death, but Mrs. Mallard was not.
67. When returning to her room, Mrs. Mallard was pressed down by _____ both physically and mentally.
68. Mrs. Mallard's dull stare indicated a _____ of deep thinking rather than a sign of contemplation.

Questions 69—70

Choose the best answer according to the passage.

69. What was Mrs. Mallard's first reaction on hearing her husband's death?

- A. She pulled herself together with the help of her sister.
- B. She stayed in her room and refused to meet anyone.
- C. She abandoned herself into grief for a while.
- D. She couldn't stop weeping and crying.

70. How did Mrs. Mallard feel towards her husband's death at the end?

- A. Bitter but relieved.
- B. Fearful but relaxed.
- C. Dull and desperate.
- D. Calm and suspicious.

Section D (10 marks)

Questions 71—75 are based on the following passage.

No creatures can stride as human beings. They are not physically designed to support and balance a vertical body balanced on two long lower limbs, propelled forward by a foot engineered exclusively for body support and forward propulsion and to do so with a stride at high-speed locomotion. While other bipeds walk in a similar fashion, human walk is unique. Bipedalism by itself offers no comparison with the distinctive human gait form. And, significantly, no other biped can actually cover more than a tiny fraction of the walking distance that can be sustained by humans.

Striding requires a special design of hip, knee, and ankle joints, plus an arched foot, plus long lower-limb bones. These "finishing touches" demanded extended evolutionary time. Striding provided numerous advantages over the simple stepping gait. For example, the ability to cover twice the distance with the same number of steps is a definite survival advantage. It also added much speed to running, more height to jumping.

None of this would have been possible without, first, a foot equipped to support and balance an erect body and to produce the leverage necessary to propel the body forward in locomotion. The ape foot was not suited for this. A new kind of foot was essential if those hominids were to become full-scale bipeds. Indeed a pair of human feet has one-fourth of all the body's 206 bones and 244 joints. Why this extraordinary number of bones and joints concentrated in such a small part of the body? (74) Because the intricate network of the many different parts required not only for supporting and balancing a heavy superstructure but to enable the multiple motions and actions, hundreds or thousands of times daily. No other part of the body comes even close to the amount and degree of stresses imposed on it.

The human foot had to go through an extensive evolutionary development in which it underwent enormous design changes in cohering its 28 bones, 37 joints and 107 ligaments, and 32 muscles and tendons to adapt to the body weight and numerous torsions. (75) In fact, it probably wasn't until only about 400,000 years ago that early humans were fully striding, the final touch of human gait. Orthopedist Philip J. Mayer writes in the Orthopedic Review: "The development of a true stride on an orthopedic foot was the most crucial of all the steps of human evolution." Nature had perhaps never undertaken an anatomical engineering project of such complexity.

Questions 71—73

Answer the following questions according to the passage.

71. What is the difference between humans and other bipeds regarding walking distance?
72. Why is the human foot equipped the way it is?
73. What kind of evolution has the human foot undergone?

Questions 74—75

Translate the underlined sentences in the passage into Chinese.

74. Because the intricate network of the many different parts is required not only for supporting and balancing a heavy superstructure but to enable the multiple motions and actions, hundreds or thousands of times daily.
75. In fact, it probably wasn't until only about 400,000 years ago that early humans were fully striding, the final touch of human gait.

Part V Translation (10 marks)

Translate the following sentences into English, using the hints given in brackets. Remember to write the answers on the Answer Sheet.

76. 有人建议, 中国所有的博物馆都应对中小学生免费开放, 使他们有更多机会获得广博的知识。(access)
77. 校方对此次违纪事件既没有处罚相关责任人, 也没有对其他师生解释原因。(倒装)
78. 在制定预算时候, 他们忘记考虑价格上涨的因素, 因此才导致目前资金紧张。(account)
79. 连年的战争不仅使人们丧失了对生活的热情, 还让他们失去了对未来的希望。(deprive)
80. 此次团队训练留给我印象最深的是队员表现出的勇气、毅力和奉献精神。(主语从句)

Part VI Error Correction (10 marks)

Proofread the passage as required. Each indicated line contains a maximum of one error. Correct the passage in the following way: for a right line, put the sign "✓" in the corresponding blank; for a wrong word, underline the wrong word and write the correct one in the blank; for a missing word, mark the position of the missing word with the sign "Λ" and write the word you believe to be missing in the blank; for an unnecessary word, cross the unnecessary word with the sign " \ " and put the word with the sign " \ " in the blank. Remember to write the answers on the Answer Sheet.

For example:

One of my favorite writers are Charlotte Brontë. She was born in the early nineteenth century when women had far fewer opportunities Λ they have now. She lived in a small village in Yorkshire and she took great pleasure in walking on the moors where near her home.

is

than

✓

where

Pyramid City is an even more ambitious project to solve Tokyo's housing problem. A 1,000-metre tall pyramid, 12 times higher than the Great Pyramid of Giza in Egypt, would contain 55 smaller pyramids, each of them would be the size of the Giza original. If it is built, the pyramid will consist in a series of skyscrapers suspended from the inside of the structure, the pyramid will be 80 storey high, with parkland in-between the skyscrapers. Three quarters of a million of people will live there. The skyscrapers will be linked by series of hollow tubes containing a high-speed transport system. Parts of the construction, include more than 150 kilometers of tunnels, will be built by spider robots, and power will be provided by waves and wind.

A major problem is that Japan is situating on the seismic "ring of fire"-an area of volcanic activity where stretches around the Pacific Ocean. Pyramid City will have to withstand earthquakes, tsunamis and underwater volcanic eruptions.

The designers of Pyramid City are certain that it will be built and make safe from earthquakes, but probably not for another 100 years.

81. _____

82. _____

83. _____

84. _____

85. _____

86. _____

87. _____

88. _____

89. _____

90. _____

Part VII IQ Test (5 marks)

There are *five* IQ Test questions in this part. Write the answers on the *Answer Sheet*.

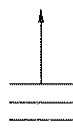
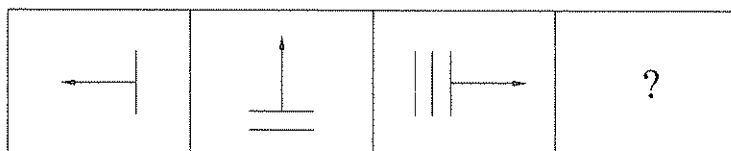
91. A frog, a skunk (臭鼬), and a duck went to the movies. The admission was \$ 1.00. Who did not get in?

92. What's the phrase represented by the following picture?



93. I am very fragile. When you say my name, you break me. What's my name?

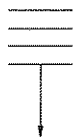
94. Which picture comes next?



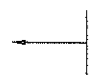
A.



B.



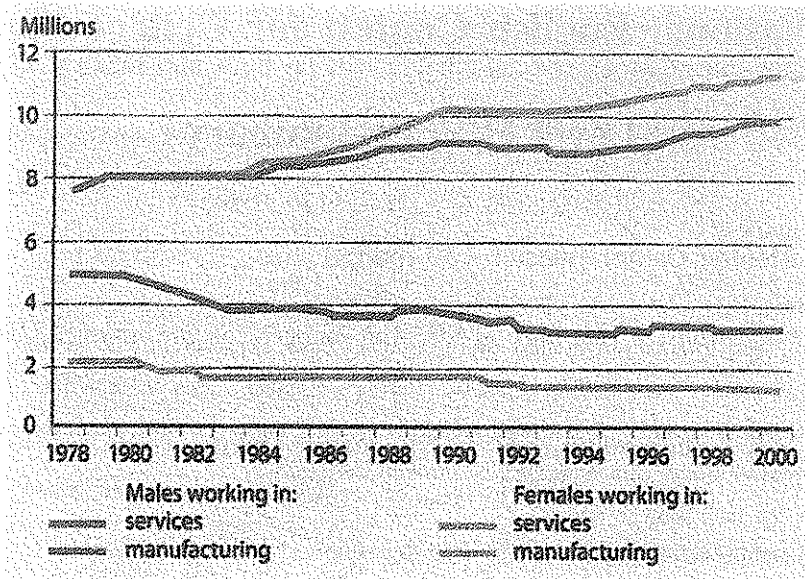
C.



D.

95. There is a four-digit number made with 1-9! Its 2nd digit is twice greater than its 3rd. The sum of all the digits is thrice greater than its last digit! The product of its 3rd and 4th digits is 12 times greater than the ratio of its 2nd to 3rd. What is it?

Part VIII Writing (30 marks)



Task I (10 marks)

UK: More service industries, less manufacturing

Study the change in world of work in the U.K. and write a report based on the information given in the chart. You should state the information, explain possible reasons and draw your conclusion.

You should write about 100 words in an appropriate style on the Answer Sheet.

Task II (20 marks)

College students have many ways to finance their college education. They may get help from their parents, find part-time jobs, apply for loans, or win scholarships. Which ways do you think are better for college students to choose in order to cover tuition fees and other living costs? Give your ideas and state your reasons for it.

Write an article of about 140 words in an appropriate style on the Answer Sheet.